

Google Ads Starter Checklist

Campaign Setup Guide — Launch Without Wasting Budget

Most Google Ads campaigns fail in the first 30 days because of setup errors, not budget. This checklist walks through every setting, from account structure to conversion tracking, before your first ad goes live.

SECTION 1 — ACCOUNT & BILLING SETUP

Google Ads account

ount created under correct Google account (not personal Gmail)
~~B~~illing information entered and payment method verified
~~A~~Account currency and time zone set correctly (cannot be changed)

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Maximize first campaign goal set to "Website traffic" or "Leads"
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NOT "Maximize conversions" until you have 30+ conversions/month
Bidding strategy: Start on "

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SECTION 4
— AD COPY
(Responsive Search Ads)

Each RS Ad has a headline and 4 descriptions entered

Primary keyword appears in at least 3 headlines

At least one headline is pinned to position 1 (your best hook)

~~H~~eadlines include: benefit statement, social proof, urgency, and key word

~~D~~escriptions include a clear CTA: "Get a Free Quote", "Book Today", "Call Now"

~~&~~ No trademark or competitor brand

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bmission (test it live)
Thank you page exists and confirmation email is triggered

SECTION 7 — NEGATIVE KEYWORD SEED LIST (250+ terms)

Add these to your campaign-level negative list before going live. This alone can

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spend.
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